

Figure 1-8. *Arduino software download page*

From here download and install the latest version of the software for your particular operating system. Full installation instructions are available on the Getting Started page at `http://arduino.cc/en/Guide/HomePage`. Linux can be a little tricky to get installed as of this writing, so be sure to carefully follow the instructions posted.

Connecting the Arduino

With the software installed, you should be able to connect your Arduino to the USB port on your computer using an A-B USB cable. The Arduino's power indicator LED will light up on the board, letting us know that it has power and is ready to go. With a brand-new Arduino Uno, the first time that it powers up, the pin 13 LED marked L will begin to blink rapidly, letting us know that the board has been fully tested. On Windows-based PCs or older Arduino boards, it is necessary to install a driver for the Arduino's onboard USB to Serial convertor, as shown in Figure 1-9. For the latest on how to install these drivers, be sure to follow the instructions on the drivers section of the Getting Started Guide at `http://arduino.cc/en/Guide/Windows#toc4`.